



WHERE THE MONEY ACTUALLY IS

The system is the barrier. The refill is the business. Attention has been going to neither.

Systems go out close to cost, and the margin arrives later at roughly \$70 gross a keg. That makes this a subscription business wearing a brewery’s clothes. A subscription business needs people to stay home and reorder. The Tap Room needs them to come in. Eighteen months of attention went to the half that loses money.

The fix is not optimisation, it is reshaping. Running a brewery and a hospitality venue on a skeleton staff is not a resourcing problem to be solved with more hours.

The direction question moved on 18 September. The taproom is a destination for events and local business, and walk-in trade is not where the energy goes. Justin has been funding the business himself to stay open and wants to be drawing a wage inside 12 months. That is the deadline behind everything on this page.

Per-keg margin and system economics from the Discovery pack. Break-even confirmed by Justin on 18 September. Franchise shape discussed 18 September: Tap That brews centrally, franchisees run a showroom and bar from pallet-delivered kegs. Satellite tasting rooms with a cool room are the low-capital step before that. Chris’s caution stands: systemising brewing is harder than a recipe.

THE CLIMB TO 1,000

250

ACTIVE REFILLERS AT SIX MONTHS

1,000

BY YEAR THREE, GC, BRISBANE, NORTHERN RIVERS

~\$50k

BREAK-EVEN PER MONTH. CURRENT RUN RATE \$35K TO \$45K. BEST MONTH HIT IT

The cheapest growth is still the 116 in the database who bought their system elsewhere. Their objections are overcome. Nobody has to be sold on the idea of beer at home.

Partners move this number, campaigns do not. Harvey Norman, Kegland and Benchy each put Tap That in front of people who have already bought the hardware. Justin’s one-year marker is cashflow positive, with JM taking a wage.

Justin confirmed on 18 September that 250 active refillers gets the business past break-even, so the six-month number and the money number are the same number.

The climb to 1,000 is not a marketing target, it is a distribution target. It needs partners, not posts.

DECISIONS REQUIRED

- The shape question. Showroom or event space. Owner: Justin.
- Residential vs commercial. Where the energy goes.
- The Jewell split. What Jewell owns, what Harry and Justin keep, against the proposal.
- Next hire. Brewer vs wholesale plus bar coverage, hybrid.
- KPIs and growth targets. Keg system sales, active keg refillers, wholesale accounts.
- Settle \$2.55. The number on the live ad.
- The 250 date. March 2027 or Christmas 2026.

THE FIVE UNITS, AND THE CALL ON EACH

UNIT	TODAY	THE CALL
Keg systems	Sold near cost	Lease-to-buy. Plus a delivery service, Justin’s three-month item
Refills	96–113 active, residential and commercial, no push	Scale. This is the business. 250 by March 2027, 1,000 by year three
Taproom	Local business, functions and events	Destination. Events, functions, ticketed music and local business. Not walk-ins. Showroom or event space is Justin’s 30-day call
Wholesale	Approaches come in, nothing converts	Resource. Next hire is brewer vs wholesale plus bar, hybrid
Merchandise	Line five in Justin’s plan	Keep it small.

Canning is not in Justin’s plan at all. Consistent with the room.

UNIT ECONOMICS, AND THE ARGUMENT

One wholesale account is worth about ten households. That ratio is the whole case for resourcing wholesale ahead of another consumer campaign.

Members leak at 18%, non-members at 44%. Attaching membership to a system sale is the single highest-return retention move available.

\$2.55 a schooner at home, 2.5 cases for the price of one. Against \$12+ at the pub and \$80+ for a case at the bottleshop.

63% of customers said they would host a demo at their own place. That is a distribution channel sitting unused, and it costs nothing but coordination.

Two membership programmes are running against one business. If the room becomes a destination and refills lead, one of them is paying for a shape the business no longer has. Redesign both around the refill, or drop one. Justin lists a taproom membership as a three-month item, so the tension is live.

The open item is no longer which maths, it is making sure the live ad and every piece of collateral carry \$2.55.

THE CANNING QUESTION

Christy raised it. Tap That pushed back. It is not in Justin’s plan.

For: a bottle shop is where people find out the brand exists, which no keg marketing reaches. It also opens bars and restaurants that will not give up a tap.

Against: low margin, high effort, and it competes directly with the refill model this plan is built on. Tap That has already priced a small line and parked it.

What would settle it: a costed run through the cannery contact next door, priced against Earth Brew at about \$36 a four-pack.

Worth revisiting if walk-in trade is wound back and a new awareness channel is needed.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- Pausing walk-ins costs community. The room built the ambassadors. Replace it with systems before it goes, not after.
- Wholesale hire without a process. A salesperson with no CRM behind them will fail the same way the founders did.
- Chris is trapped in production. Justin’s words: highly valued and intelligent, but the business needs his time and knowledge freed up.
- Everything at once. The recurring failure has been starting things and moving on. Three moves finished beats ten started.

Justin’s own point in both catch-ups: as this scales, the personal connection cannot hold. It has to be replicated in systems. The franchise model on the summary sheet only works if it does.